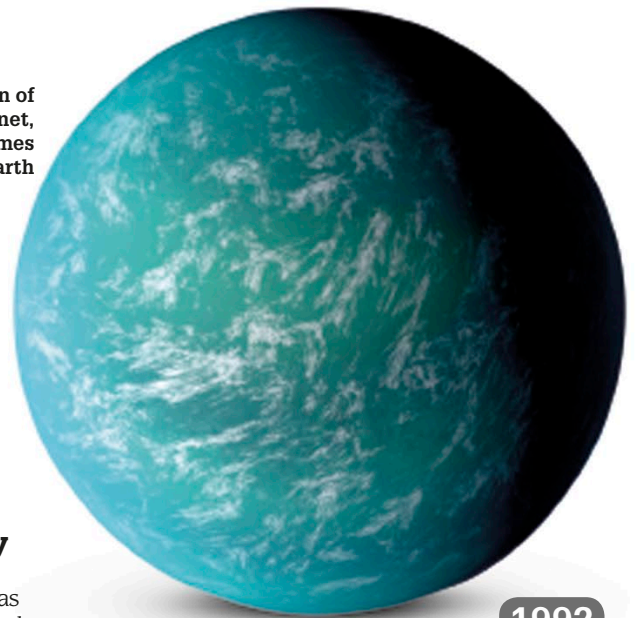


1990 ▶ 1995

Artist's impression of Kepler 22b, an exoplanet, which is around 2.4 times the size of Earth



In 1992, British engineer Neil Papworth sent the first SMS (short-message service) text, which read "Merry Christmas."



Preserved remains of Ötzi

1991

Frozen mummy

The oldest, frozen, mummified human was discovered in the Ötztal Alps on the Italy-Austria border. Dated as 5,300 years old and later nicknamed Ötzi, the figure was so well-preserved that scientists could study its stomach contents and the 61 tattoos on its body.

1992

Exoplanets

Polish astronomer Aleksander Wolszczan and Canadian astronomer Dale Frail discovered evidence of two planets orbiting a pulsar (a rotating neutron star). These were the first confirmed exoplanets—planets found outside the solar system. More than 3,300 exoplanets had been discovered by July 2016.

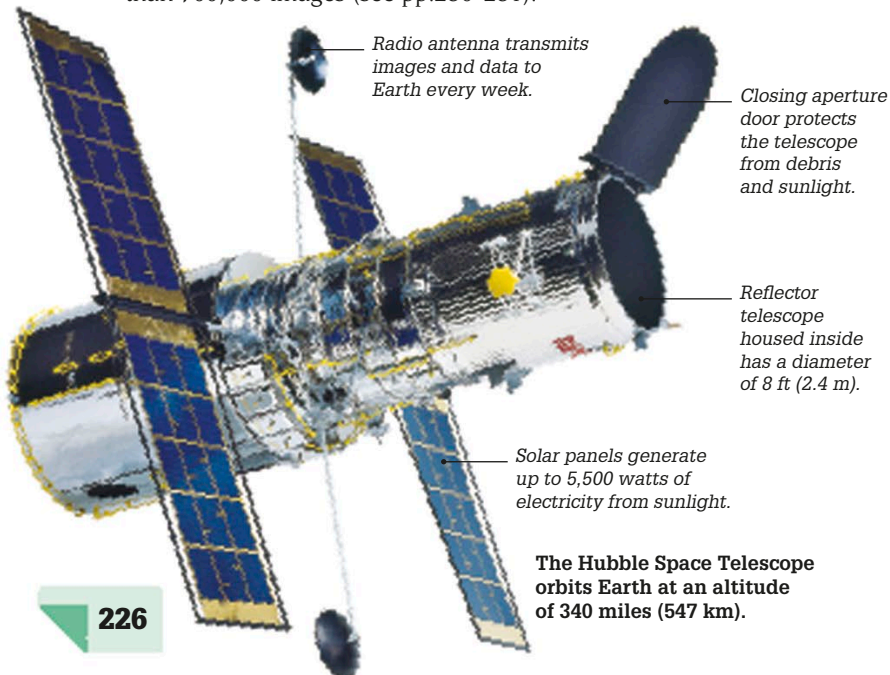


1990

1990

Hubble Space Telescope launched

Taken into space on board the Space Shuttle *Discovery*, the 43.3-ft- (13.2-m-) long Hubble Space Telescope would transform our understanding of space, discovering new stars, galaxies, and moons, and sending back more than 700,000 images (see pp.230–231).



1989–1993

WORLD WIDE WEB

In 1989, British computer programmer Sir Tim Berners-Lee founded the World Wide Web (WWW)—a global information system accessed via the Internet. It consists of websites made up of webpages connected by hyperlinks. These enable users to navigate easily between webpages and documents. The WWW is free for anyone to use.

“It was... hard explaining the Web before people just got used to it, because they didn't even have words like click and jump...”

Tim Berners-Lee